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DOST STRENGTHENS MINDANAO TEXTILE INDUSTRY WITH LAUNCH OF FIRST REGIONAL YARN PRODUCTION AND INNOVATION CENTER

KABACAN, Cotabato – The Department of Science and Technology–Philippine Textile Research Institute (DOST-PTRI), in partnership with the University of Southern Mindanao (USM), officially launched the Regional Yarn Production and Innovation Center (RYPIC) in Kabacan, Cotabato on June 5, 2026, marking a significant milestone in the development of Min-

danoo’s textile industry. As the first facility of its kind in Mindanao and the fourth in the country, RYPIC is expected to improve access to locally produced yarn, strengthen regional textile production, and create new economic opportunities for farmers, weavers, and rural communities across the island. DOST Secretary Dr. Renato U. Solidum Jr. de-

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DOST-PCIEERD, USTP open built environment laboratory in Northern Mindanao



Officials from the Department of Science and Technology-Philippine Council for Industry, Energy and Emerging Technology Research and Development (DOST-PCIEERD) and the University of Science and Technology of the Southern Philippines (USTP) open-

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Strengthening Women Through Innovation: DOST-PCIEERD Highlights WHWise Program for Women-Led Social Enterprises on Tekno PreSyensya



As part of its continuing efforts to promote women empowerment in innovation and entrepreneurship, the latest episode of Tekno PreSyensya—the official broadcast program of DOST Ilocos Region—featured the Women-Helping-Women: Innovating Social Enterprises (WHWise) Program. During the discussion titled “Fueling Women-Led Social Innovation: WHWise Program Overview and Proposal Guide,” Ms. Dolf Mirelle J. Montecillo, Project Technical Assistant VI and Assistant Program Manager for WHWise, DOST-PCIEERD, discussed the program’s goals and objectives.

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HEPE NG PULIS SA LUCENA CITY, MARIING PINATUTUNAYANG HINDI RECYCLE ANG MGA NAKUKUMPIKA NILANG DROGA SA MGA DRUG BUY BUST OPERATION



Pinaninindigan ni Lucena City Police Chief PLt-Col Ryan Hernandez, na hindi raw umano recycle ang mga nakukumpiska nilang mga ilegal na droga sa tuwing may mga Drug Buy Bust Operation silang ginagawa sa lungsod ng lucena. Sinabi pa ng Hepe ng Pulis Lucena, nasisigurado nilang ang lahat ng nahuhuli nilang droga ay maingat nilang naitatalaga sa Crime Lab ng PNP, at dahil ito ay dumadaan umano ito sa legal na proseso hanggang sa mismong pagsira. Kaya naman umabot na sa hindi bababa

sa ₱28 milyon halaga ng illegal drugs ang nasabat sa magkakahiwalay na operasyon sa iba't ibang barangay sa nasabing siyudad nitong mga nakaraang buwan. Samantala nauna nang sinabi ni Quezon Police Provincial Director PCol Romulo Albaladea, na ang mga droga ay ibinabagsak lamang sa lalawigan, mula sa kalapit probinsya, na siyang nagiging dahilan para mas paigtingin pa ang operasyon laban sa mga sangkot dito, sa siyudad na ito, at sa buong probinsya ng Quezon.

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DOST STRENGTHENS MINDANAO TEXTILE INDUSTRY WITH LAUNCH OF FIRST REGIONAL YARN... FROM PAGE 1



scribed the facility as a major step toward decentralizing innovation and bringing technology-driven development closer to communities. He noted that the establishment of RYPIC demonstrates the commitment of DOST-PTRI under the FRONTIER Program to strengthen local industries through regional innovation hubs, enabling communities to benefit directly from science and technology interventions. The center addresses a growing demand for yarn in SOCCSKSARGEN, which DOST-PTRI data identifies as one of the country's leading regions in handloom weaving communities and practicing weavers. Strategically located in Cotabato, the facility is positioned to serve weaving communities across SOCCSKSARGEN, Northern Mindanao, the Davao Region, and the Zamboanga Peninsula. According to DOST-PTRI Director Dr. Julius L. Leaño Jr., the launch of RYPIC is not only about establishing infrastructure but also about developing a textile innovation ecosystem that connects fiber producers, yarn manufacturers, weavers, researchers, local governments, and industry stakeholders. He emphasized that the initiative combines technological innovation with the region's rich textile traditions, creating a foundation for sustainable growth while preserving cultural heritage and supporting local livelihoods. The facility is expected to become a critical link in the region's growing textile value chain. Fiber sources include pineapple leaves from plantations in Polomolok, South Cotabato; abaca from Lake Sebu; and cotton from farms in Sarangani Province, all processed through the Natural Textile Fiber Innovation Hub in Tacurong, Sultan Kudarat. By transforming agricultural by-products into valuable textile materials, the initiative promotes circular economy practices while opening additional income streams for farming communities. Farmers can now derive value not only from their primary agricultural products but also from materials that were previously considered waste. DOST Undersecretary for Regional Operations Engr. Sancho A. Maborang highlighted the broader socioeconomic impact of the facility, noting that its annual production capacity of approximately 13 tons of natural textile fiber blended yarns can help generate sustainable livelihood opportunities for rural communities throughout SOCCSKSARGEN and the rest of Mindanao. He underscored that the initiative demonstrates the growing competitiveness of Philippine natural textile fibers and their potential to meet both local and international market demands. The project is expected to directly benefit farming groups such as the POLO Multi-Purpose Cooperative and Sta. Cruz Multi-Purpose Cooperative, while supporting approximately 1,982 handloom weavers across Mindanao through improved access to locally produced yarn. Further strengthening the region's textile industry, DOST-PTRI is also advancing the development of a bamboo textile fiber facility in Maragat, Bukidnon. The upcoming facility will process underutilized bamboo species into textile fibers, complementing the operations of RYPIC and expanding the range of sustainable raw materials available for yarn production. Once fully operational, the center is projected to produce between 50 and 75 kilograms of yarn daily, equivalent to approximately 270 meters of handloom-woven fabric measuring one meter in width. With yarn valued at around ₱1,800 per kilogram, the facility is expected to generate between ₱25 million and ₱72 million in annual revenue while reducing dependence on imported yarn and stimulating greater weaving activity throughout Mindanao. Through investments in regional innovation infrastructure, sustainable fiber development, and community-based production systems, RYPIC represents a significant step toward building a resilient Philippine textile industry that creates opportunities from farm to fabric while empowering communities across Mindanao.

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OFFICE ADDRESS:
B18 L14 Ph10 Oxygen St. Dasma 4 Golden City Barangay Salawag,
Dasmariñas City, Cavite 4114 Philippines Cel # 09176275522
Email Ad: wisdom.cavite@gmail.com
Fb Page: Wisdom Newspaper
Website: cavitewisdom.com

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DOST-PCIEERD, USTP open built environment laboratory... From page 1



(USTP) inaugurate the Built Environment Laboratory (BEL) at the USTP Cagayan de Oro campus on May 28. The facility will support research on energy-efficient building designs and construction materials suited to tropical climates. (Photo courtesy of the USTP Strategic Communication Office) CAGAYAN DE ORO CITY (PIA) — The Department of Science and Technology-Philippine Council for Industry, Energy and Emerging Technology Research and Development (DOST-PCIEERD) and the University of Science and Technology of the Southern Philippines (USTP) inaugurated the Built Environment Laboratory (BEL) on May 28 at the USTP Cagayan de Oro campus. The facility will serve as a research center for studying, developing, and testing building designs and construction materials suited to tropical climates. The laboratory aims to support efforts to reduce carbon emissions and lower energy consumption in academic and urban structures. Project leader Engr. Richard Jayson Valera said the laboratory seeks to address increasing energy demands for cooling amid rising temperatures. “Ang atuang main goal dinhi, e-relate natin sa current nga sitwasyon sa kalibutan, is para e-minimize gyud natin ang consumption sa air conditioners. If ma-minimize natin ang consumption sa air conditioners, magamay ang consumption sa university,” he said.

(Our main goal here, relating it to the current situation of the world, is to really minimize the consumption of air conditioners. If we can minimize the consumption of air conditioners, the consumption of the university will decrease.) Equipment at the Built Environment Laboratory (BEL) includes diagnostic and modeling tools, including fluid flow and thermal simulation software used in building performance research. (Photo courtesy of the USTP Strategic Communication Office) Valera said the laboratory will use engineering tools and localized weather data to study passive cooling strategies, climate-responsive building systems, and technologies that help regulate indoor temperatures while reducing energy use. He added that the research outputs from the facility will support the university’s operations and provide data that local government units and private developers can use to plan and design energy-efficient buildings in Mindanao. The project is part of the collaboration between DOST-PCIEERD and USTP to advance research on energy-efficient and climate-responsive infrastructure in Northern Mindanao. It supports President Ferdinand R. Marcos Jr.’s push for climate resilience, energy efficiency, and science-driven innovation as part of the country’s sustainable development agenda.

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Strengthening Women Through Innovation: DOST-PCIEERD Highlights WHWise Program... From page 1



Manager of the WHWise Program, shared valuable insights about the initiative, including practical guidance on developing a strong WHWise proposal following the extension of the application deadline until June 5, 2026. Launched in 2021 by the Philippine Council for Industry, Energy and Emerging Technology Research and Development (DOST-PCIEERD), the WHWise Program supports women-led social enterprises through technology, research and development (R&D), technical assistance, and mentoring. The program aims to strengthen the capacity of women social entrepreneurs to create greater impact in their communities and among marginalized sectors through innovative and sustainable solutions. According to Ms. Montecillo, the WHWise Program plays a vital role in helping women-led social enterprises expand their services and social impact. Through the program, women entrepreneurs are empowered to maximize science, technology, and innovation in improving their operations and reaching more communities. She also emphasized the program’s “multiplier effect,” where the success of one women-led enterprise inspires more women to pursue their own community-driven initiatives. During the interview, Ms. Montecillo encouraged aspiring women entrepreneurs to pursue

innovation despite the challenges of balancing various responsibilities. She highlighted the availability of support systems such as Technology Business Incubators (TBIs), innovation hubs, DOST programs, and other capacity-building initiatives that can guide women throughout their entrepreneurial journey. She also assured the public that DOST offices and the WHWise Program remain open to assisting applicants in proposal development and innovation planning. Ms. Montecillo further clarified that proposals that are not immediately approved may still be improved and resubmitted in future application cycles, depending on the reason for disapproval. She explained that the program aims not only to provide funding opportunities but also to help social enterprises strengthen their capabilities and connect them with the most suitable support mechanisms. Through Tekno PreSyensa, DOST Ilocos Region continues to bring science, technology, and innovation programs closer to the public, particularly to women aspiring to become catalysts for positive change in their communities. The agency encourages women-led social enterprises and aspiring social entrepreneurs in Region 1 to take advantage of this opportunity and submit their concept proposals before the extended deadline.

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SHOWBLITZ
By: Charlene Mae
Windang sa dami ng fans...Linda Walker, nangarag sa ‘Pinas!



Grabe ang schedule ng Chinese actress Zhang Yingfei, a.k.a. Linda Walker. Parang wala ata siyang naging tulog umpisa nang dumating siya ng Manila. Hehehe. Dumating sa Manila si Zhang na sumikat sa super-hit Chinese vertical micro-drama na The Heiress Who Won With Brains sa imbitasyon ng Federation of Filipino Chinese Chambers of Commerce & Industry, Inc. (FFCCCII) kasabay ng pagbubukas ng eskwelahan sa bansa. Kaya naman overwhelmed si Zhang sa naging pagtanggap sa kanya ng Pinoy fans na bukod sa mga presscon at fan meeting ay napanood din siya sa Unang Hirit, Agenda at It’s Showtime. Na-interview rin siya ni Jessica Soho. At ang cute niya kahit parang nag-arag na, lalo na at game siya sa pagtikim ng mga lutong Pinoy at dance challenge. Pero kahit nawindang sa hectic schedule, aniya ay happy siya. “I was very happy, I really enjoyed doing all of these. Everybody was so warm and friendly. It was really busy, the itinerary is really full but I really enjoy what I’m doing.” At paulit-ulit niyang sinabi na importante sa kanya ang edukasyon. “In China, there’s this saying that, ‘Education could change your destiny,’ pagdidiin niya sa pamamagitan ng kanyang interpreter sa press conference na ipinatawag ng FFCCCII.

“So I encourage everybody to study hard and do your best because that could change your lives,” dagdag niya. Thoroughly alam ni Zhang na hindi laging madali ang pag-aaral. Sabagay hindi pa man siya dumarating ng bansa ay inspirasyon na siya ng maraming estudyante. “I’d like to take the role of Linda Walker. She’s very persevering, brave and never backs out. She always does her very best. So maybe Linda Walker could be a very great role model,” paalala niya pa sa mga estudyante na minsan ay sinusukuan na ang pag-aaral. Nagbigay rin siya ng advice sa mga estudyanteng may pinagdaanan sa mental health. “But at the same time, for those who are dealing with mental health problems, it’s very important to take care of your health because if you have good health you could do anything,” aniya pa sa pamamagitan pa rin ng kanyang interpreter. Super cute si Zhang na walang kapaguran at lag-ing naka-smile. May ilang nagduda na AI (artificial intelligence) sa nasabing vertical drama series. “I invite you all to please check it out so you’ll know I’m not AI. I’m a living, breathing human being,” dagdag niya pa sa mga kahirap na mga entertainment media noong isang araw.

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SPORTS NEWS

Brownlee, abarrientos pinarangalan sa Game 4



MANILA, Philippines — Tulad ng inaasahan, kinoronohan sina RJ Abarrientos at Justin Brownlee ng Barangay Ginebra Gin Kings bilang Best Player of the Conference at Best Import, ayon sa pagkakasunod, ng PBA Season 50 Commissioner’s Cup kahapon bago ang Game 4 ng finals sa Smart-Araneta Coliseum.

Kumulimbat ng 1,147 puntos si Abarrientos upang masukwat ang kanyang unang BPC award sa kanyang ikatlong taon palang sa Asia’s oldest professional league buhat ng maging No. 3 overall pick noong 2024. Dinig ni Abarrientos sina Robert Bolick ng NLEX at June Mar Fajardo ng San Miguel na may 804 at 573 puntos, ayon sa pagkakasunod, bilang lider ng BPC derby sa elims subalit natanggal agad ang kanilang mga koponan sa quarterfinals.

Kandidato rin sina Ricci Rivero ng Phoenix at Jerick Ahanmisi ng Terrafirma na may 431 at 421 puntos, ayon sa pagkakasunod. Sumibol si Abarrientos bilang best local player sa likod ng rehistrong 21.5 points, 3.6 rebounds, 5.1 assists at 1.2 steals sa 19 na laro papasok sa finals.

Sa bahagi ni Brownlee, nasungkit niya ang ika-4 na Best Import award at una simula noong 2023 bilang resident import ng Ginebra matapos humakot ng 29.5 points, 9.8 rebounds, 6.1 assists, 1.67 steals at 1.3 na tapal.

Umani ng 1,264 puntos si Brownlee mula sa stats, media at players upang pumangalawa ngayon sa listahan ng pinakamaraming Best Import awards sa likod lang ng alamat na si Bobby Parks na may 7 parangal.

Tinalo ni Brownlee sina Jaylen Johnson ng Rain or Shine (888), Chris McCullough ng Talk ‘N Text (690) at Patrick Gardner ng Merlaco (534).

Si Bol Bol ng TNT ang trangko ng karera sa BPC subalit nadale ng Achilles injury sa semifinals kontra sa Meralco.

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